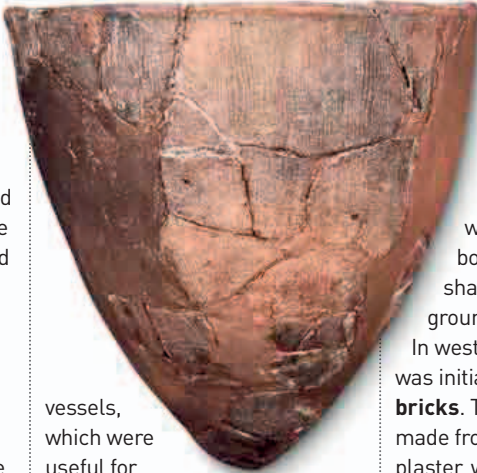




Einkorn is the ancestor of modern wheat and still occurs naturally throughout southwest Asia. It has a higher protein content than its domesticated descendent.

date from around 9000 BCE. The arrows of this period show evidence of fletching—attaching feathers to the shaft to improve flight and accuracy. The first deliberate use of fire to harden clay dates from around 24,000 BCE, with the manufacture of ceramic Venus figurines found at Dolni Vestonice in the Czech Republic. Examples of the **first pottery vessels**, from around 18,000 BCE, were found in Xianrendong Cave in China, but the earliest ceramic vessels to have survived in any quantity are Jomon pots **from Japan**. These date from about 14,000 BCE and were probably used for cooking food. The growing stability of settlements probably played a role in the spread of pottery



Jomon pot
This style of pottery was produced in Japan for over 10,000 years. The earlier examples generally have pointed bottoms.

vessels, which were useful for storing food and also for cooking. Early pottery was generally formed by pinching (shaping the wet clay by hand) or gradually coiling rolls of clay up and into the shape of a pot. These pots

were **fired in pit-kilns**, or bonfire kilns, which were shallow pits dug in the ground and lined with fuel. In western Asia, unbaked clay was initially used for **making bricks**. The first containers were made from gypsum and lime plaster, which was made by burning chalk. It was not until around 6900 BCE that ceramic pottery appeared at sites such as Çayönü in Turkey.

The **earliest bone needles** date from around 30,000 BCE and come from Europe. They may have been **used to join skins** together, using threads of gut or sinew, and to thread pierced objects, such as shells or beads. Ancient clay impressions of textiles date the **first woven cloth** to around 27,000 BCE. **Cordage**—the twisting together of fibers to increase the strength of the threads—appeared around 18,000 BCE, when **three-ply cord** was in use in the Lascaux caves of southern France.

Until at least 13,000 YA, early humans were hunter-



DEVELOPMENT OF AGRICULTURE

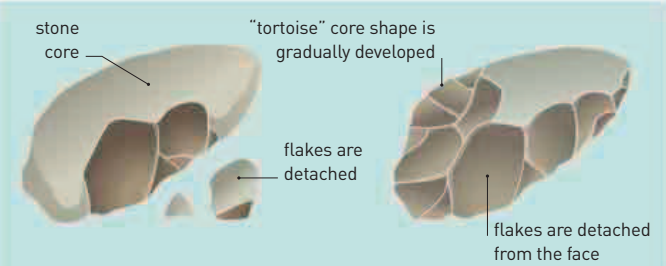
The upland areas of the Fertile Crescent, an area of relatively fertile land in southwest Asia, were home to wild cereals, sheep, and goats. Around 10,000 BCE the climate cooled, leading to a contraction of the range of wild cereals to areas with higher rainfall. Perhaps due to the greater difficulty in gathering the seeds of these plants, communities began cultivating them next to their villages. Sheep and goats were also domesticated for their meat. More productive sources of food led to increased population densities, while the demand in time and labor needed for agriculture led to settlements becoming both larger and more sedentary.

gatherers or foragers. The first evidence of **plant domestication** (the deliberate selection and manipulation of plants for cultivation) is of wild rye seeds that were sown and harvested around the settlement of Abu Hureyra in Iraq around 10,500 BCE. About a thousand years later, a group of **wild cereals**—notably einkorn (*Triticum boeoticum*) and emmer (*Triticum dicoccoides*), both varieties of wheat, and wild

barley (*Hordeum vulgare*)—were domesticated. Cultivation of these cereals was widely distributed in southwest Asia, particularly in a fertile crescent of land that stretched from the Persian Gulf to the coastlands of the Near East. By 7000 BCE, **barley had also been domesticated on the Indian subcontinent**. In China, however, a different set of plants, notably millet and rice, was domesticated beginning in the 8th millennium BCE.



Bone shuttle
Needles and shuttles of bone were the first means of binding materials together, using animal gut or vegetable fibers such as flax.



THE LEVALLOIS TECHNIQUE

This technique involves shaping a “tortoise” core using hard and soft percussion. Flakes are struck from the edges and one face to produce the desired shape of the final flake, which is then detached from the core. The resulting flake has a sharp edge on all sides and can be used without further modification.

